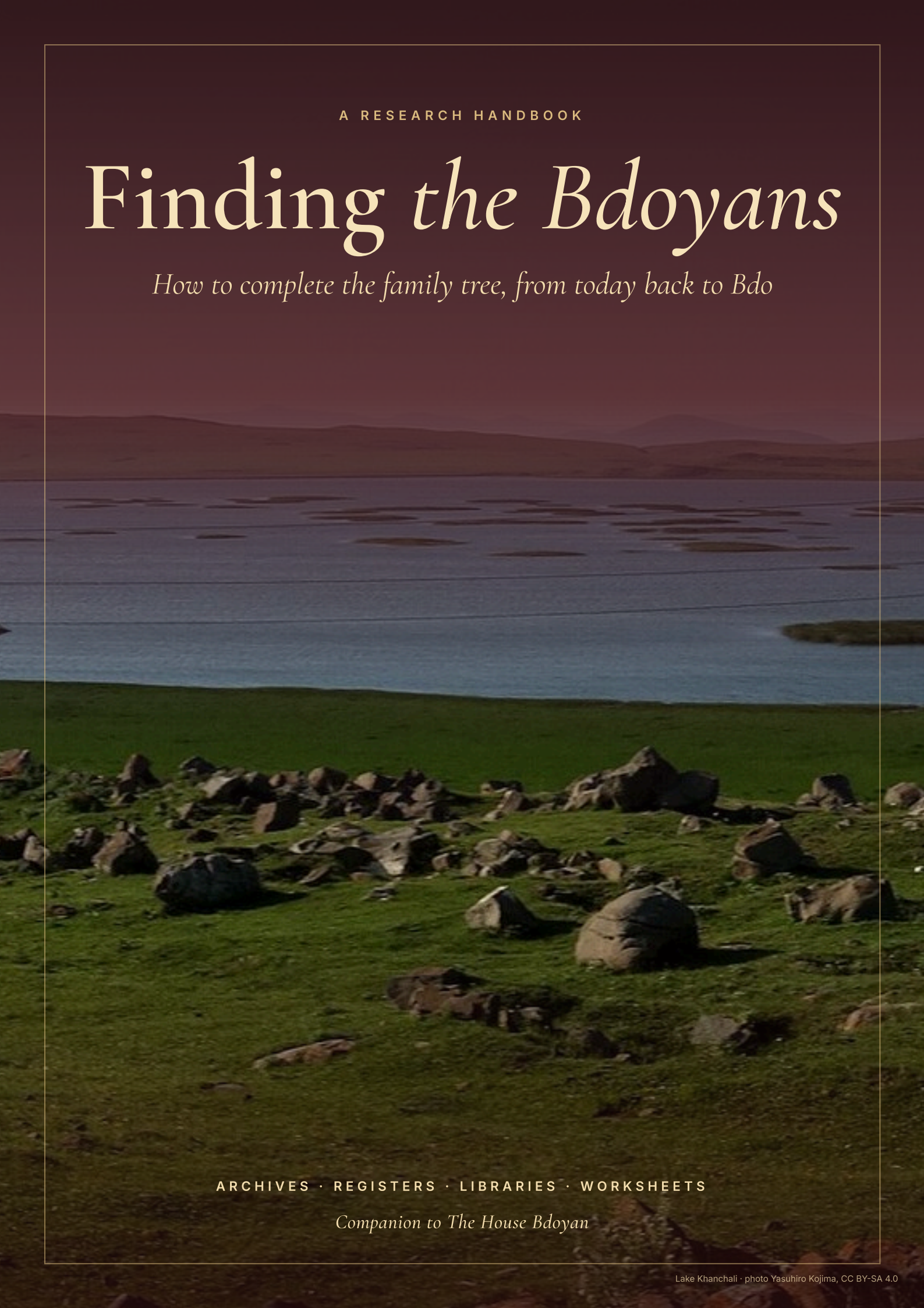
A RESEARCH HANDBOOK

Finding *the Bdoyans*

How to complete the family tree, from today back to Bdo



ARCHIVES · REGISTERS · LIBRARIES · WORKSHEETS

Companion to The House Bdoyan

Lake Khanchali · photo Yasuhiro Kojima, CC BY-SA 4.0

A RESEARCH HANDBOOK

Finding *the Bdoyans*

How to complete the family tree

A companion to *The House Bdoyan: A History of the Bdoyan Family*

by Harutyun Bdoyan

Working edition · October 2026

WHAT THIS HANDBOOK IS FOR

The House Bdoyan tells the family's story as far as the sources reach today. This handbook is the working half: where every record is kept, how to ask for it, what to look for in it, and printable sheets for collecting what each branch knows. Every web address in it is a link.

HOW TO USE IT

Start with Chapter I and follow the steps in order: the living first, then the Soviet records, then the church registers, then the first Russian lists. Chapters II and III are the full list of sources, online and on paper. Chapter IV holds the sheets: print as many as you need.

SHARE WHAT YOU FIND

Send each finding, with its source, so it can go into the next edition of the book. The online edition has a Contribute section that turns your answers into a ready message: claude.ai/artifact/FcnSZy3zKiXexgTckt51aL. Or write to harut.bdo116@gmail.com.

PRIVACY

Write down living people only with their agreement, and share their dates and addresses only with the family. The book names living people only where a published source already does.

PICTURES AND SOURCES

Cover photograph: Lake Khanchali panorama by Yasuhiro Kojima, Wikimedia Commons, CC BY-SA 4.0; cropped and overlaid with the title, and this cover adaptation is likewise shared under CC BY-SA 4.0. Archive references are as published by the archives and by the authors named in Chapter II. Research and drafting were done with the help of Claude, an AI model made by Anthropic; check each reference against the archive's own catalogue before ordering copies.

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The full tree from Bdo to today can be rebuilt. The method is to start with the living and work backwards, one generation and one record at a time. This handbook says where each record is and how to read it.

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THE FIRST THREE THINGS TO DO

This month
Record the oldest Bdoyan you know, and copy the family's photographs and papers.

Next
Open FamilySearch films 1915055 and 1915180: the church registers of Pokr Khanchali.

Then
Ask two Bdoyan men from different branches, one from Abul, to take a Y-DNA test.



“They acquired not only single houses, but whole quarters.”

VARD BDOYAN, ON THE SETTLERS OF 1830

Chapter I THE GUIDE

Finding the Exact Family Tree

The full tree from Bdo to today — the Armenian *tohmatsar* — can be rebuilt. The method is to start with the living and work backwards, one generation and one record at a time.

Each period of the family's history left a different kind of record, kept in a different place. Think of the search as five layers, from the present back to Bdo:

Today → 1930s

LIVING MEMORY

Elders, family papers, photos, letters, gravestones. Quickest and most important.

1991 → 1920s

SOVIET CIVIL RECORDS

Birth, marriage and death certificates in Georgia and Armenia.

1920s → 1830s

CHURCH REGISTERS

Baptisms, marriages and burials at St Hakob, Pokr Khanchali.

1897 → 1830s

IMPERIAL LISTS

Household lists and censuses naming each man and his father.

Before 1830

KARIN

The hardest layer. Few Ottoman records name villagers.

FOUND · THE REGISTERS OF POKR KHANCHALI

The village's church records are in Yerevan — and on microfilm

VILLAGE	ARCHIVE REFERENCE (NATIONAL ARCHIVES OF ARMENIA)	FAMILYSEARCH FILM
Pokr Khanchali	Fond 53 (Consistory of Georgia & Imereti), series 2, items 2868–2897	1915055
Pokr Khanchali	Fond 357, series 1, items 37–38	1915180
Mets Khanchali	Fond 53, series 2, items 2837–2867 · Fond 357, series 1, item 36	1915055 1915180
Abul	Look up "Abul", Akhalkalaki district, in the same parish index	see index
Church history files	Fond 53, series 1, files 3800, 3848, 3912, 3977 · Fond 56 (Etchmiadzin Synod), series 15, file 52	archive only

Baptisms, marriages and burials that the Armenian church authority for Georgia collected from its parishes, as listed in the archive's own parish index (published in English by FEEFHS). In the FamilySearch catalogue look under **Georgia (Republic) – Church records – Consistory of Imeretiya, Gruziya**. A free account is needed, and some films can only be viewed at a FamilySearch centre.

Step by step

1

Begin with the elders

Record (audio or video) the oldest Bdoyans, especially anyone born in Pokr Khanchali before about 1960. Ask for names, nicknames, the branch or "house" within the family, where each brother went, and who married whom. Copy every document and photograph, and write down who is in each picture.

Where: every Bdoyan household. Share the results, because each branch remembers a different part.

2

Read the stones

Photograph every Bdoyan gravestone in the cemetery around St Hakob in Pokr Khanchali, and in Ninotsminda and Akhalkalaki. Note names, dates and any patronymic ("son of …"). Gravestones often fill gaps for the late 19th and early 20th centuries.

Where: Pokr Khanchali church cemetery; town cemeteries of Javakhk.

3 Collect civil records

For people born or married after the 1920s, request certified extracts of birth, marriage and death records. Close relatives can usually request them; for older entries the archive of the civil registry may need to be searched.

Georgia: Public Service Development Agency (civil registry, Ministry of Justice). **Armenia:** Civil Status Registration Agency, Ministry of Justice.

4 Search the church registers (metrical books)

From the 1830s until about 1920, the priests of St Hakob kept registers of baptisms, marriages and deaths. Copies went to the diocesan consistory in Tiflis. Each entry names the parents, so you can climb back a generation at a time.

First search: the 1887 marriage of Harutyun Bdoyan and Varvare. The entry should name Harutyun's father, the first of the two generations between Bdoyents Papo and the householders of the 1910s; that father's own baptism, in the same registers, gives the next. **Start with:** FamilySearch films 1915055 and 1915180 (see the box above). **Then:** National Archives of Armenia, Yerevan (archives.am), for the original files; and the Central Historical Archive in Tbilisi (archive.gov.ge), whose online finder lists about 400 metrical books from 177 Armenian churches in Georgia. Ask for "Pokr (Patara) Khanchali, Akhalkalaki uyezd" — Tiflis governorate from 1867, Kutais governorate before that.

5 Find the first Russian lists

The household lists and descriptions drawn up in the 1830s–1880s, the family lists of 1886 and the 1897 census list every household head with his sons and their ages. The earliest of these, made soon after 1830, are the most likely documents to name Bdo's sons or grandsons with their fathers' names — the bridge back to Bdo himself.

Where: National Archives of Georgia (Tbilisi), where a professional archive researcher can locate and photograph the Khanchali pages. **Online now:** the printed 1887 summary of the 1886 family lists for the Akhalkalaki district, with totals for every village, is scanned by the Russian State Public Historical Library (elib.shpl.ru) and the Presidential Library (prlib.ru).

SEARCH EVERY SPELLING

The name appears in Armenian script in Armenian records (the form is given in the Armenian edition), as **Бдоян** in Russian and **ბდოიანი** (Bdoiani) in Georgian records, and as Bdoyan, Bdojan or Bdoian in Latin script. Older documents may write the clan form, "of the house of Bdo".

READING A REGISTER

Entries are in Armenian, later partly in Russian. A baptism gives the child's name, the dates of birth and baptism, and both parents' names; a marriage names the fathers of bride and groom. Each entry lets you climb one generation.

ASK FOR THESE, IN RUSSIAN

метрические книги — metrical (church) books
посемейные списки — family lists, 1886
камеральные описания — household descriptions
перепись 1897 года — 1897 census

6 Read Vard Bdoyan's book, then look for his notebooks

His 2014 book is free online. Its notes on storytellers (pp. 707–738) give names, birth years, parents and marriages, and pp. 148–152 describe the village house by house (both used in Chapter VI of *The House Bdoyan*). Every note cites one of his field notebooks ("personal archive no. 79", and so on): ask his descendants, the book's editor and the Institute where those notebooks are now.

Read: The Ethnography and Folk Art of the Armenians of Javakhk (YSU Press, 2014), arar.sci.am. **Ask:** Institute of Archaeology and Ethnography, 15 Charents St, Yerevan (iae.am); Yerevan State University Press; the History Museum of Armenia; the Akhalkalaki regional museum.

7 Test DNA

Ask two or three Bdoyan men from different branches — one of them from the Abul line — to take a Y-DNA test (Y-37 or higher), and join the Armenian DNA Project. Matching results confirm a shared male-line ancestor. Autosomal tests (such as AncestryDNA, MyHeritage or FamilyTreeDNA Family Finder) help connect cousins through female lines.

Where: FamilyTreeDNA, Armenian DNA Project (familytreedna.com).

WHICH TEST?

Y-DNA (men only) follows the unbroken father-to-son line and can prove descent from Bdo.
Autosomal (anyone) finds cousins on all sides, back about five or six generations.

8 Build and share one tree

Put everything into a single shared online tree, cite the source for every fact, and invite each branch to add its own line. Send each finding for the book too (see the last page).

Where: FamilySearch (free, familysearch.org), Geni or MyHeritage. On FamilySearch, also search the indexed collection **Armenia, Church Books, 1838–1929** (about 94,000 names) for every spelling: the Armenian-script form, Бдоян and Bdoyan.

Questions to ask the elders

- ☐ What was your father's name, and his father's, as far back as you know? (The old ideal was *yot port* — seven generations.)
- ☐ Which branch are we — which of the five houses in Pokr Khanchali (Harutyun's, Grigor's, Anton and Davit's, Mesrop's, Zakar's), and who lived there with whom?
- ☐ What is remembered of Bdo's full name, of Bdoyents Papo and his mill, and of the Bdoyans of Abul?

- ☐ Which brothers or cousins left, when, and where did they go?
- ☐ Who married into the family, and from which villages and families?
- ☐ Are there documents, letters, Bibles or photographs with names and dates written on them?

WHERE TO WRITE OR VISIT · every online source is in Chapter II, archives and books in Chapter III

BACKGROUND ON KARIN

For the villages of the Karin plain before 1915, see the Houshamadyan project (houshamadyan.org), which documents the Armenian towns and villages of the Ottoman Empire. Ottoman records from before 1830 rarely name individual villagers, so the earliest Russian lists are the realistic bridge to Bdo.

National Archives of Georgia

1 Vazha-Pshavela Ave, Tbilisi · archive.gov.ge

National Archives of Armenia

5/2 Hrachya Kochar St, Yerevan · archives.am

Institute of Archaeology & Ethnography

15 Charents St, Yerevan · iae.am



His father's household numbered thirty-three people, and five cradles were rocking in the house at once.

A MAN OF DINARIGOM, REMEMBERING · 1959

Chapter II OPEN SOURCES

Sources Online

II

Everything found online about Bdo's family, Pokr Khanchali and Vard Bdoyan — what each source holds and how to reach it. Sources that exist only on paper, in archives or in family hands are in Chapter III.

How to use this list

Each source carries one or two labels. They tell you what you will find there and what you need to do to see it.

FREE ONLINE	Open the address and read it straight away. Nothing to sign up for.
FREE ACCOUNT	The site is free, but asks you to register first with your e-mail and a password (FamilySearch, Academia, FamilyTreeDNA). Create the account yourself; never give your password to anyone else.
CATALOGUE ONLY	The page does not show the documents themselves. It tells you which documents exist, where they are kept and the numbers you need to ask for them.
READ NEXT	Available online but not yet read for this book. These are the most promising places to look for new names.

The address in the right-hand column can be typed into any web browser. In the PDF and on the website it is also a link you can click.

SOURCE	WHAT IT HOLDS	WHERE
Parish records of Pokr Khanchali	FREE ACCOUNT Baptisms, marriages and burials sent to the church authority in Tiflis; National Archives of Armenia fond 53/2, items 2868–2897, and 357/1, items 37–38.	FamilySearch films 1915055 · 19 15180
Armenian parish locality index	FREE ONLINE Every Armenian parish in Armenia, Georgia and Azerbaijan with its archive numbers and FamilySearch films (S. Mirzoyan, 1998; English by K. Mehr).	former.feefhs.org/links/armenia/
FamilySearch: Armenia, Church Books, 1838–1929	FREE ACCOUNT About 94,000 indexed names from the archive in Yerevan; search every spelling of Bdoyan.	familysearch.org/search/collection/1943754

SOURCE	WHAT IT HOLDS	WHERE
Fond 53 catalogue description	FREE ONLINE CATALOGUE ONLY Archives of the Armenian church authority of Georgia and Imereti, 1804–1924, 4,081 files.	openjerusalem.org · fonds AM-HAA/53
Central Historical Archive of Georgia: metrical-book finder	FREE ONLINE CATALOGUE ONLY Which church books survive, by church, place and year: about 400 books from 177 Armenian churches.	archive.gov.ge
Pokr Khanchali – Surb Hakob church	FREE ONLINE Church history: 1875 rebuilding, priests, school, 2015 restoration (its 1840 figure seems to be Mets Khanchali's).	armenianchurch.ge
Yervand Lalayan, *Javakhk* (1895–96)	FREE ONLINE READ NEXT The first full ethnography of Javakhk (*Azgagrakan Handes*): villages, inhabitants, statistics, homes, dress, customs; may give each village's origins and size.	archive.org/details/Javakhk · ar ar.sci.am
Samvel Karapetian, *Javakhk* (RAA, 2006; English 2011)	FREE ONLINE Village-by-village survey built on the diocesan archive. Read: Pokr Khanchali, pp. 530–532; Mets Khanchali, pp. 375–377; Abul, pp. 29–30.	raa-am.org/en/javakhk/
Summary of the 1886 family lists, Akhalkalaki district (Tiflis, 1887)	FREE ONLINE READ NEXT Houses and people of every village in 1886.	elib.shpl.ru · prlib.ru
V. Bdoyan, *The Ethnography and Folk Art of the Armenians of Javakhk* (2014)	FREE ONLINE His Javakhk book (752 pp., ed. R. Gharibyan): farming, crafts, houses, village plans, customs, folklore, and a note on every storyteller — many of them Bdoyans.	arar.sci.am · publication 292396 · publishing.ysu.am
Ashot Melkonyan, *Javakhk: Outlines of History* (1999)	FREE ONLINE History of Javakhk; the 1829–30 settlement (p. 15) and 1918–21. In Armenian.	arar.sci.am (Pan-Armenian Digit al Library)
Acts of the Caucasian Archaeographic Commission (AKAK), vol. 7 (1878)	FREE ONLINE READ NEXT Papers of Paskevich's command, 1827–1831, including the resettlement from Erzurum.	openlibrary.ge (National Parliam entary Library of Georgia)
H. F. B. Lynch, *Armenia: Travels and Studies* (1901)	FREE ONLINE READ NEXT Javakhk villages in the 1890s; quoted by Vard Bdoyan.	archive.org
S. Hobosyan, "Bdoyan Vard (1910–1986)" (2026)	FREE ACCOUNT READ NEXT New biography from the Institute of Archaeology and Ethnography.	independent.academia.edu/Sur enHobosyan
Digitised Armenian newspapers, 1794–1920s	FREE ONLINE READ NEXT 59 titles scanned by the National Library of Armenia (EAP613); look for the issues in Chapter III.	nla.am · eap.bl.uk (EAP613)

SOURCE	WHAT IT HOLDS	WHERE
National Library of Armenia union catalogue	FREE ONLINE CATALOGUE ONLY Library copies of Vard's books and of the works in Chapter III.	armunicat.nla.am
H. Acharyan, *Dictionary of Armenian Personal Names* (1942–62)	FREE ONLINE Every Armenian given name with its pet forms and early bearers; explains names like Bdo and Papo.	archive.org (Hrarm5–Hrarm9)
R. Nahapetyan, Vard Bdoyan centenary (2010)	FREE ONLINE The fullest biography of Vard Bdoyan and list of his works.	arar.sci.am/Content/253651/file_0.pdf
V. Bdoyan, *Armenian Ethnography: A Brief Outline* (1974)	CATALOGUE ONLY His 287-page textbook. Not online: the Pan-Armenian Digital Library has a review; copies in the National Library of Armenia.	nla.am · arar.sci.am (review)
V. Bdoyan, wedding customs recorded in the 14th century (1956)	FREE ONLINE Article in *Banber Matenadarani* 3.	archive.org/details/Bdoyan1956BM03Harsaneakank
"Javakhk" Encyclopedia portal	FREE ONLINE Biographies and village articles; lists Vard Bdoyan and other natives of Pokr Khanchali.	javakhk.am
Armenian Wikipedia and Wikidata	FREE ONLINE Vard Bdoyan and village articles (Pokr Khanchali: 2014 census); Wikidata Q30038186.	hy.wikipedia.org · wikidata.org
Soviet Armenian Encyclopedia: "Karin" district	FREE ONLINE The 1909 list of the 48 Armenian villages of the Karin district, including Dinargom.	hy.wikisource.org
Houshamadyan	FREE ONLINE Towns and villages of Ottoman Armenia before 1915, including the Erzurum region.	houshamadyan.org
Armenian DNA Project	FREE ACCOUNT Y-DNA and autosomal comparison with other Armenian families.	familytreedna.com



The man christened Petros lived on as Bdo.

CHAPTER I

Chapter III OFFLINE SOURCES

Sources Not Online

III

The records that will finish the tree are mostly on paper — in archives, libraries and family hands — or carved in stone. Many are cited in the books used here, so we know exactly where to look.

How to use this list

These sources exist only on paper or in stone. The label says where they are and how to see them.

ARCHIVE Original handwritten documents kept in a state archive. You can read them in the archive's reading room (take your passport and ask for the fond, series and file numbers given here), or write to the archive and order paid copies or scans. A professional researcher can do this for you.

PRINT A published book or newspaper. Ask for it at a large library: the National Library of Armenia in Yerevan holds almost all of them, and most libraries will copy a few pages on request.

ON SITE Something to see in person: a church inscription, a gravestone, a museum object. Take clear photographs and write down where and when each was taken.

PRIVATE Papers kept by a family or a person, such as Vard Bdoyan's notebooks or your own family's letters and photographs. Ask the owner, explain what the book is for, and offer to share copies.

Addresses of the main archives are on the last page of Chapter I.

SOURCE	WHAT IT HOLDS	WHERE
ARCHIVES		
National Archives of Armenia, fond 53, series 1	ARCHIVE The original files of the Armenian diocese of Georgia and Imereti: yearly parish counts for Pokr Khanchali, 1853–1912 (files 2743, 3825–3920), and church and school files (3800, 3848, 3912, 3977). Not on microfilm.	5/2 Hrachya Kochar St, Yerevan · archives.am
National Archives of Armenia, other fonds	ARCHIVE Village counts for 1908–1921 (35/1/559; 56/6/1020; 196/1/43; 469/3/2; 355/1/895), school records (56/3/52) and the parish registers of fond 357 (also on film 1915180).	Yerevan

SOURCE	WHAT IT HOLDS	WHERE
National Archives of Armenia, 1918–1921 files	ARCHIVE Reports on the war, refugees and borders of the Akhalkalaki district (fonds 114 and 200, used by Melkonyan) — the background to Mesrop Bdoyan's death at the Dilif pass in 1918.	Yerevan
National Archives of Georgia, Central Historical Archive	ARCHIVE Original metrical books of the Armenian churches of Georgia; the 1886 family lists; household descriptions; returns of the 1897 census; papers of the Tiflis governorate for the Akhalkalaki district.	1 Vazha-Pshavela Ave, Tbilisi · archive.gov.ge
Ottoman state archives	ARCHIVE Population registers of the Erzurum villages from the 1830s on, which may name the Armenians who stayed in Dinarigom and Umudum. Registers from before 1829 seldom name villagers.	Presidency State Archives, Istanbul
Pokr Khanchali village administration	ARCHIVE Soviet-era village council household books (the source of the 1987 figure) and later registers.	Ninotsminda municipality, Georgia
Civil registries	ARCHIVE Birth, marriage and death records from the 1920s on.	Georgia: Public Service Development Agency · Armenia: Civil Status Registration Agency
PAPERS, MUSEUMS AND PLACES		
Vard Bdoyan's personal archive	PRIVATE His field notebooks — nos. 19, 65, 67, 68, 75, 79, 126 and 127 are cited in his 2014 book — with photographs and drawings, and the original texts of everything the Bdoyans told him.	His family; R. Gharibyan, compiler of the 2014 book
Institute of Archaeology and Ethnography; History Museum of Armenia	ARCHIVE His field materials at the Institute (1959–1986); records of the Museum's ethnography department (1944–1959).	15 Charents St (iae.am) and Republic Square, Yerevan
St Hakob church and cemetery; Akhalkalaki museum	ON SITE The 1875 inscriptions and 19th–20th-century gravestones; the 300 or so objects Vard gave the museum in 1961.	Pokr Khanchali · Akhalkalaki
Family papers and elders	PRIVATE Names, photographs, letters, Bibles and memories — the first layer of the tree.	Every Bdoyan household
PRINTED BOOKS AND NEWSPAPERS		
Vard Bdoyan's other books	PRINT *The Cult of Land and Child Fertility* (1950), *Armenian Folk Games* (1963–1983), *Agricultural Culture in Armenia* (1972), *Armenian Ethnography* (1974), *Armenian Salt-Cellars* (1986).	National Library of Armenia; library of the Academy of Sciences, Yerevan

SOURCE	WHAT IT HOLDS	WHERE
Village studies cited by Karapetian	PRINT A. Davtyan, *Javakhk* (1994): Second World War losses (p. 101); S. Khudoyan, *Eastern Armenian Schools in 1830–1920* (1987): the parish school (p. 518); S. Aroyan, *Bekorner Msho jojkari* (1997): the 1926 figures (p. 125).	National Library of Armenia
A. Sanosyan, *The 1918 Self-Defence of the Akhaltsikhe and Akhalkalaki Districts* (Yerevan, 1992)	PRINT The fighting of May 1918, in which Mesrop Bdoyan fell.	National Library of Armenia
Histories of Javakhk	PRINT A. Melkonyan, *Javakhk in the 19th Century and the First Quarter of the 20th* (2003), a fuller history of the settlement and villages; S. Zurnajyan, *Javakhk: Chronology* (2002).	National Library of Armenia
N. Kirakosyan, *Ghunkianos, Singer of Karin* (Yerevan, 1995, 1997)	PRINT The Karin poet whose long song the Abul Bdoyans kept, by Vard's account.	National Library of Armenia
Older descriptions of the villages	PRINT *Sbornik materialov dlya opisaniya Tiflisskoy gubernii*, vol. 1 (1870): the Tarakama houses, Abul's mills; *Kavkazskiy kalendar na 1915 god*: 608 people in 1914; N. Berdzenishvili's diary of the 1933 Javakheti expedition (in Georgian, 1964): the village in the 1930s.	Russian and Georgian national li braries
Armenian newspapers	PRINT *Meghu Hayastani* (1875), *Ardzagank* (1885), *Murch* (1894), *Mshak* (1918): reports on the church, school and village, and on 1918. *Aspnjak* (Javakhk) printed the first excerpts of Vard's Javakhk ethnography.	National Library of Armenia; so me issues scanned (Chapter II)



When the elders of Pokr Khanchali speak the village tongue, they are still using the words of the Karin plain.

CHAPTER III

Chapter IV WORKSHEETS

Worksheets

IV

WORKSHEET 1

Your Line Back to Bdo

Fill in your own male line, from yourself at the bottom up to Bdo at the top. Write a source next to every name (an elder, a certificate, a register, a gravestone). Leave gaps blank until a record fills them, and add rows if your line is longer.

	NAME	BORN – DIED	PLACE	SOURCE
I	Bdo (Bedros)	c. 1740–1780	Dinarigom, Karin	Family; Karapetian, p. 530
II				
III				
IV				
V				
VI				
VII				
VIII				
IX				
X	NAME (YOU)	BORN	PLACE	SOURCE

WORKSHEET 2

Family Group Sheet

One sheet for each couple: the two spouses and all their children. In Armenian and Russian records, the father's name is the key to the next generation up, so always write it down.

Husband

FULL NAME

FATHER'S NAME

BORN · DATE | PLACE

MARRIED · DATE | PLACE

DIED · DATE | PLACE

BURIED AT

SOURCES

Wife

FULL NAME

FATHER'S NAME

BORN · DATE | PLACE

MARRIED · DATE | PLACE

DIED · DATE | PLACE

BURIED AT

SOURCES

#	CHILD'S NAME	BORN · DATE, PLACE	MARRIED TO · VILLAGE	DIED	SOURCE
1					
2					
3					
4					
5					
6					
7					
8					
9					

NOTES · STORIES · PHOTOGRAPHS OF THIS FAMILY

WORKSHEET 3

Where Our Branch Lives Today

One sheet per branch. It replaces the estimates in Chapter VII of the book with facts. List each household of the branch; write a name only if that person agrees, and give the town and country, not the address.

OUR BRANCH (HOUSE IN POKR KHANCHALI, ABUL, AKHALKALAKI OR OTHER)

THE OLDEST ANCESTOR WE KNOW, WITH DATES

OUR VILLAGE BEFORE WE MOVED | WHEN WE MOVED

FILLED IN BY | DATE

HEAD OF HOUSEHOLD	HOW RELATED TO THE OLDEST ANCESTOR	TOWN, COUNTRY	SINCE	PEOPLE	MAY WE LIST IT?

WORKSHEET 4

Research Log

Write down every search, including the ones that found nothing: a record that is not there is a finding too, and the log stops anyone repeating the same search.

DATE	WHERE I LOOKED	WHAT I LOOKED FOR	WHAT I FOUND · EXACT REFERENCE	NEXT STEP

Last page SHARE WHAT YOU FIND

Share What You Find

Every branch remembers a different part of the family. The book can only be completed if what each branch knows comes together in one place.

What to send

- ☐ Your branch: the house it comes from, the oldest ancestor you know, and where its households live today (Worksheet 3).
- ☐ Names and dates for any generation, each with its source: an elder's memory, a certificate, a register entry with its archive reference, a gravestone.
- ☐ Stories, memories and songs, with who told them and when.
- ☐ Photographs and documents: a scan or a clear phone photo, with who and what is in them.
- ☐ Corrections to anything in the book, with the reason.
- ☐ An offer to help: visiting an archive in Yerevan or Tbilisi, reading Russian or Georgian records, or taking a DNA test.

Pictures we are looking for

- ☐ St Hakob church in Pokr Khanchali, inside and out, and its 1875 inscriptions.
- ☐ Old family photographs: Vard Bdoyan, Mesrop and Anush, the five houses, weddings, Papo's mill.
- ☐ Bdoyan gravestones in Pokr Khanchali, Abul and Akhalkalaki, with the inscription readable.
- ☐ The Karin plain and Dinarigom (today Myratgeldi), if anyone travels to Erzurum.

How to send it

The online edition of *The House Bdoyan* has a **Contribute** section. Fill in the form, and the page writes your entry as a message you can send by email, WhatsApp, Viber or Telegram: claude.ai/artifact/FcnSZy3zKiXexgTckt51aL.

Or write directly to harut.bdo116@gmail.com. Nothing you send is published without your agreement, and living people are named only if they agree.

HOW A FINDING BECOMES PART OF THE BOOK

Each new fact is checked against its source, given a mark (● confirmed by a record, ◐ probable, ○ family tradition), added to the family chart and the who's who, and credited to the person who sent it in the next edition.



Yot port — seven generations of ancestors, as every Armenian was expected to know them.

AN OLD SAYING

FINDING THE BDOYANS

The church registers of Pokr Khanchali survive. So do the first Russian household lists, the census of 1897 and the notebooks of Vard Bdoyan. Somewhere in them is Bdo's baptismal name, and the names of the two generations still missing from the family chart.

This handbook lists every archive, library and website that holds a piece of the Bdoyan story, explains how to ask for each record and how to read it, and gives the sheets for collecting what every branch knows.



Companion to: The House Bdoyan — A History of the Bdoyan Family
Online edition and contributions: claude.ai/artifact/FcnSZy3zKiXexgTckt51aL
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